

SNIPPETS

Mobile number portability by August!

The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) is planning to start mobile number portability (MNP) in major Indian cities by August and in the remaining cities by the end of this year. Bids had already been invited for providing the MNP switches. The faster penetration of 3G would enable people to use the services with greater accessibility.

BSNL rolls out 3G services

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL) has launched next-generation 3G mobile services in the country even as the private operators are still waiting to get spectrum through auction process. BSNL and public-sector unit MTNL (for Delhi and Mumbai) were given 3G spectrum last year ahead of auction for private players keeping in mind the cumbersome tendering process involved in the public-sector procurement system.

By 2011, Kerala to get ten IT parks

It will be a matter of time when Kerala will develop as the preferred IT destination in India, as the state would soon be equipped with over ten IT parks. According to Ajay Kumar, secretary, Information Technology, Kerala, the hub-and-spoke model of development being undertaken in Kerala's information technology sector will enable the state to equip itself with over ten IT parks at various destinations by 2011.

Samsung to invest in Chennai and Noida facilities

Samsung India is going to invest \$20 million in its Chennai and Noida facilities this year to expand operations. Last year, the company had invested \$200 million as part of its global expansion plans. It had reported a turnover of \$1.7 billion last year and has projected to grow 27 per cent approximately this year.

China Mobile considering acquisition in India

China Mobile, which has the world's largest number of subscribers (457 million), is considering an acquisition in India for expansion. The company, however, might face hurdles in India over security issues, especially because it has operations in Pakistan.

forts to increase market share despite the volatile economic situation. To achieve this, LG has reorganised its business portfolio to focus on areas with longer-term growth potential and profitability. Partnerships will continue to be a key element of the company's marketing activities to elevate its brand position.

LG will continue to invest in future growth engines such as solar power, commercial air-conditioners and B2B solutions.

Sharp, Sony postpone LCD production

Faced with changes in the world economy, Sharp and Sony have decided to postpone the establishment of their joint venture to produce and sell large-size LCD panels and modules, until March 2010.

The duo will, through continued

discussions of how the two companies can best deploy their resources and expertise, continue to negotiate in good faith and have set June 30, 2009 as the target date by which to enter into a definitive agreement to establish a joint venture that will be mutually beneficial for both companies.

Sharp plans to start operating its new LCD panel factory in Sakai-City, Osaka, by March 2010 as originally scheduled.

LG may shut down PC business, to focus on low-cost handsets

LG is likely to shut down its PC business globally owing to lower market response amidst economic slowdown. The company's IT vertical contributes only 10 per cent to its overall revenues, and it will not have any impact on its

electronics consumer market.

The company, however, plans to focus on low-end handset emerging markets this year with the aim of boosting its global handset market share to more than 10 per cent from 8.5 per cent last year.

"The global handset market in 2009 is expected to shrink by about 5 per cent to 10 per cent led by weaker demand in developed countries," said Skott Ahn, president of LG's mobile communications division. "But emerging nations are expected to grow over 10 per cent (this year). Thus, we have to focus on emerging markets to maintain our growth," Ahn said.

Ahn also said that the company is targeting to increase the proportion of low-end handsets it sells to more than 20 per cent this year, from around 5 per cent in 2008.

Low-end handsets refer to mobile phones that are typically sold to consumers for less than \$100.

Forecast for PV cell and module manufacturing equipment

According to VLSI Research Inc., the photovoltaic (PV) cell and module manufacturing equipment market for all cell technologies reached a value of \$4.4 billion in 2008. Growth in the market is expected to slow to 8 per cent in 2009 as demand for cells starts to cool and smaller manufacturers struggle to secure the financing necessary to fund the next round of expansion.

However, the outlook for equipment suppliers this year varies by cell technology. Providers of equipment for thin-film cell technologies will experience strong growth in revenues in 2009 due to large order backlogs and long customer acceptance times. In contrast, suppliers of equipment for silicon wafer cell manufacturing are expected to see a decline from 2008 levels as customers with excess capacity choose to fully ramp existing facilities before committing to new equipment. Overall, this results in growth of 8 per cent for the year.